

A Trio of Quaker Scientists



Graham Waterhouse and Peter Murray-Rust
Jesus Lane Meeting House, 2025-09-18

Early Lives

Name	Place of birth	Family	Education
John Dalton	Cumberland	Poor Quaker	Local Quaker School, individual mentors, self-taught
William Allen	Spitalfields, London	Merchant class Quaker	Quaker School, Rochester, mentors, self-taught
Kathleen Lonsdale	Co. Kildare, Ireland	Poor Baptist	Ilford High School, Bedford College, London

The SPICES Principles

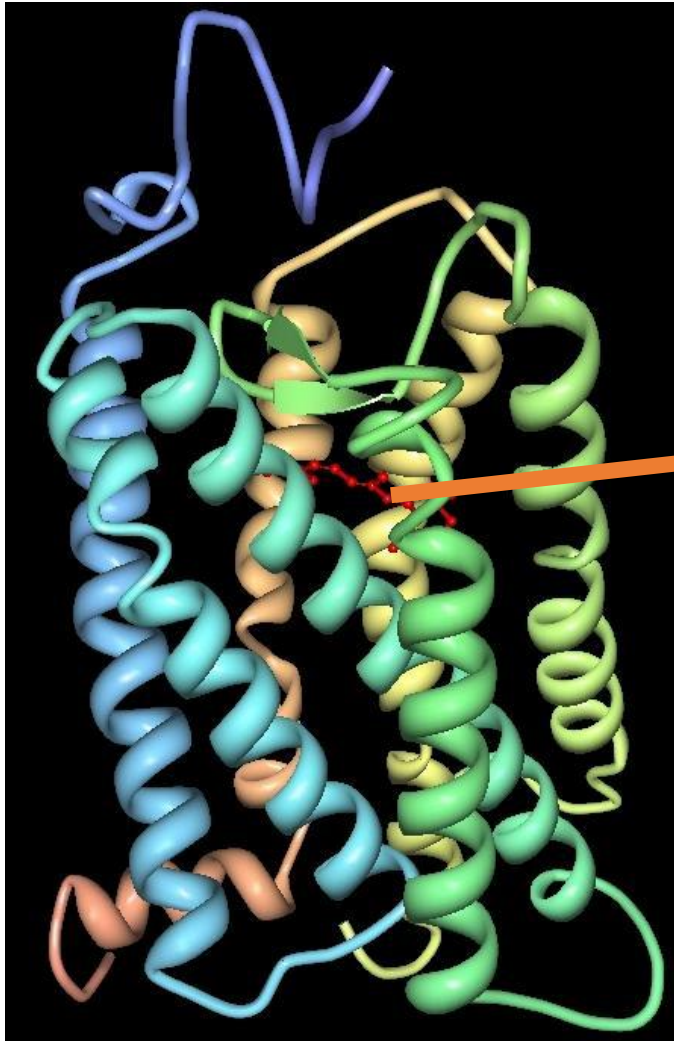
- Simplicity:
- Peace:
- Integrity:
- Community:
- Equality:
- Stewardship:

Themes:

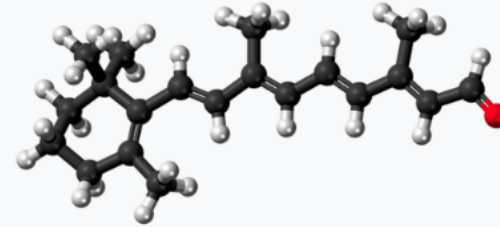
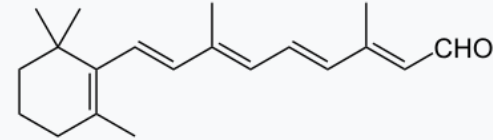
- Science + religion
- Education, Quaker schools
- Outreach
- Dissension

The finding of one generation will not serve for the next. It tarnishes rapidly except it be reserved with an ever-renewed spirit of seeking.

Arthur Eddington



All-trans-retinal



Names

IUPAC name

Retinal

Systematic IUPAC name

(2E,4E,6E,8E)-3,7-Dimethyl-9-(2,6,6-trimethylcyclohex-1-en-1-yl)nona-2,4,6,8-tetraenal

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Vertebrate_visual_opsin

Three-dimensional structure of bovine rhodopsin. The seven transmembrane domains are shown in varying colors. The retinal [chromophore](#) is shown in red.

Wikipedia

Atoms responsible
for John Dalton's
colour blindness

Knowledge Graphs for the scientists

Cursor AI was used to generate knowledge graphs of relatives, mentors/mentees

[William Allen](#)



WILLIAM ALLEN

1770-
1843

Businessman + Scientist

"---cheerful, in the light around me thrown
Walking as one on pleasant service led,
Doing God's will as if it were my own,
Yet trusting not in mine
but in his strength alone"

J.G. WHITTIER



2 Plough Court



Royal Institution Lectures



Lindfield Agricultural Settlement

John Dalton FRS.
1766-1844

ELEMENTS

○ Hydrogen ^{Wt}	○ Strontian ^{Wt}
○ Azote 5	○ Barytes 68
● Carbon 5 ₄	○ Iron 50
○ Oxygen 7	○ 7



Crystallographer

Dame Kathleen
Lonsdale, DSc FRS.

1903-71



$C_6(CH_3)_6$
HEXAMETHYL
BENZENE

4

Live up to the Light thou hast + more will be granted thee.

SCIENTISTS X-ray
Atomic Chemist • Astrophysicist • Crystallographer

John Dalton FRS.
1766-1844

ELEMENTS	
Hydrogen 1	Strontian 88
Nitrogen 14	Barytes 137
Carbon 12	Iron 56
Oxygen 16	



Brilliant
Hot Stars



Coal
Faint Stars



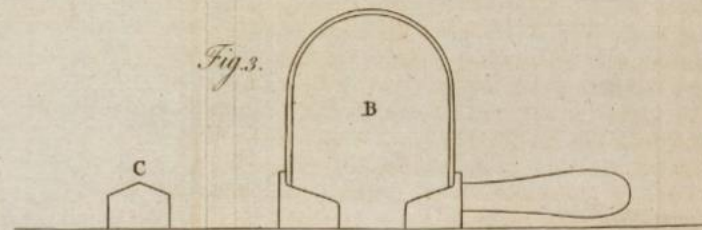
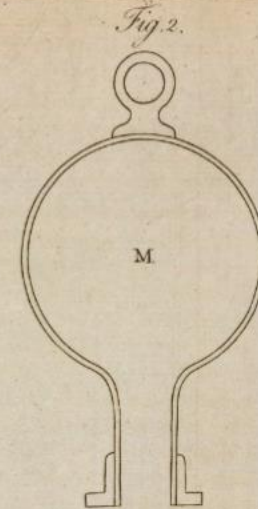
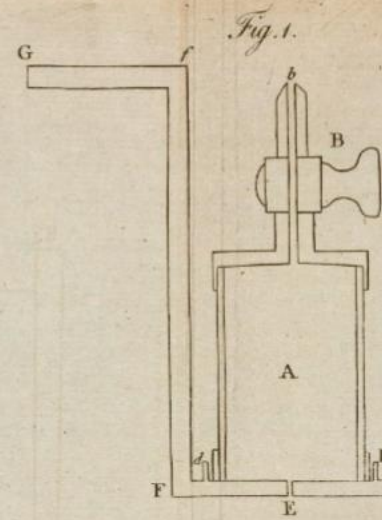
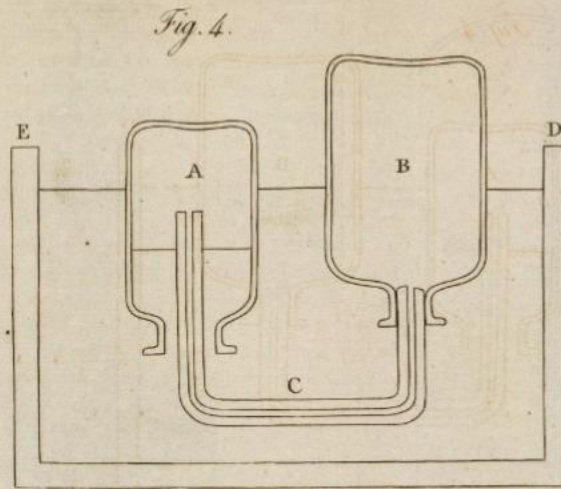
Sir Arthur
Stanley Eddington
O.M. FRS. 1882-1944

Dame Kathleen
Lonsdale DSc FRS.
1903-71



HEXAMETHYL
BENZENE

The immensities of ordered space and time, gravitation, and the minute structure of matter set before us by the Scientists enrich and ennoble our idea of the creative processes of GOD.



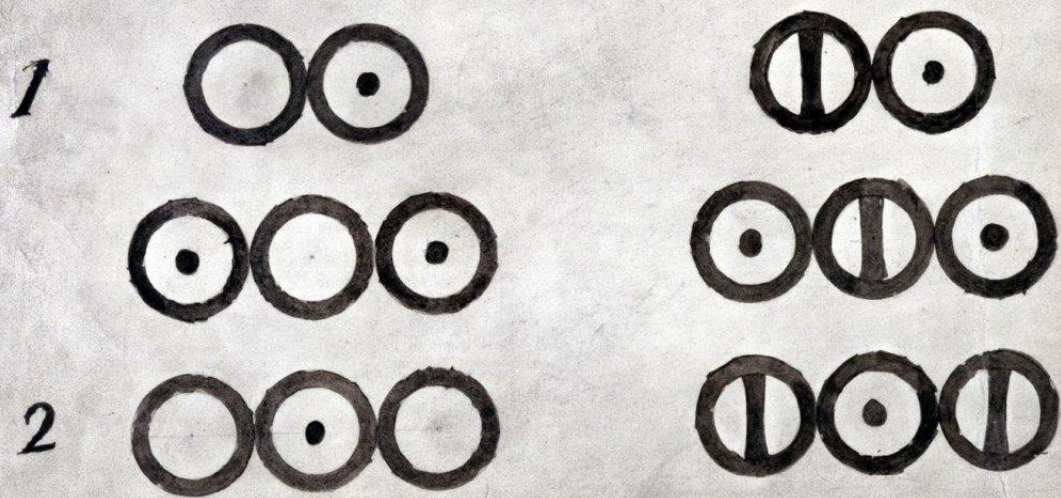
ELEMENTS.

	Hydrogen.	1		Strontian	46
	Azote	5		Barytes	68
	Carbon	54		Iron	50
	Oxygen	7		Zinc	56
	Phosphorus	9		Copper	56
	Sulphur	13		Lead	90
	Magnesia	20		Silver	190
	Lime	24		Gold	190
	Soda	28		Platina	190
	Potash	42		Mercury	167

ELEMENTS.

1		Strontian	^{Wt} 46
5		Barytes	68
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a 20		Silver	190
24		Gold	190
28		Platina	190
42		Mercury	167

WATER AMMONIA

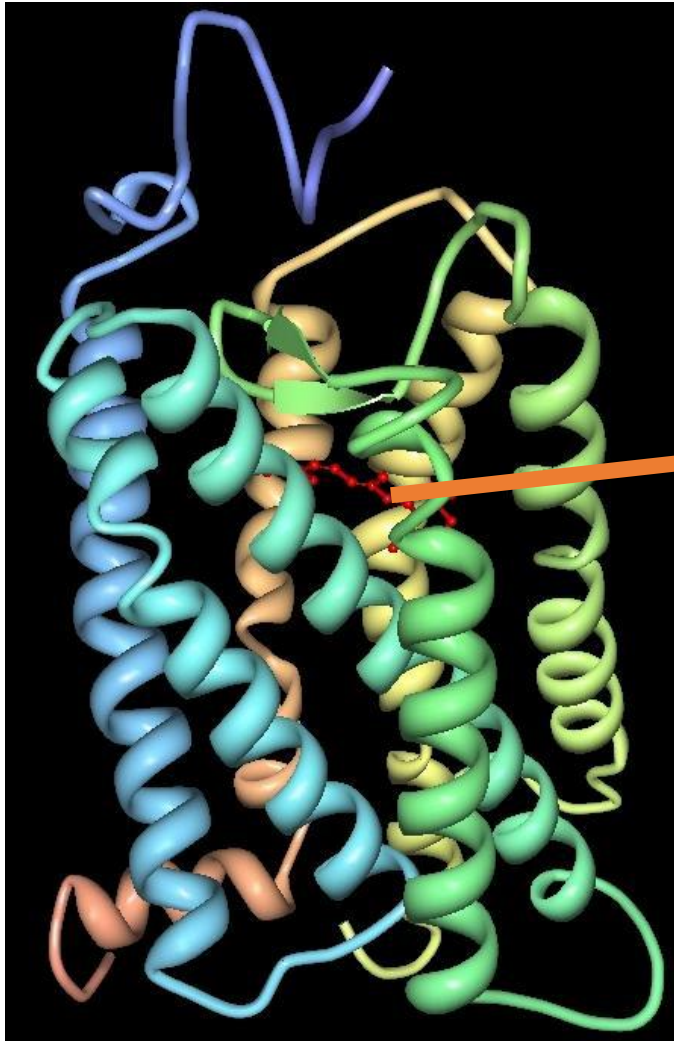




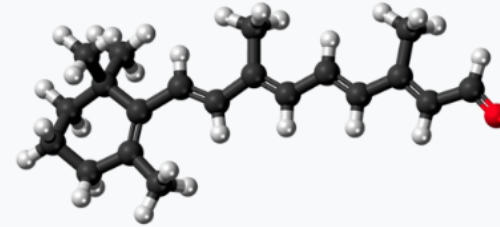
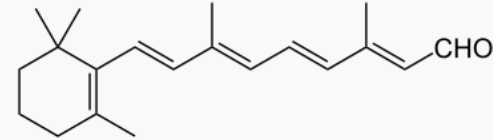
Five wooden balls, made by Peter Ewart of Manchester c.1810, and used by John Dalton for demonstrating his atomic theory c. 1810–

42

Science Museum Group Collection



All-trans-retinal



Names

IUPAC name

Retinal

Systematic IUPAC name

(2*E*,4*E*,6*E*,8*E*)-3,7-Dimethyl-9-(2,6,6-trimethylcyclohex-1-en-1-yl)nona-2,4,6,8-tetraenal

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Vertebrate_visual_opsin

Three-dimensional structure of bovine rhodopsin. The seven transmembrane domains are shown in varying colors. The retinal [chromophore](#) is shown in red.

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for John Dalton's
colour blindness



<https://www.quaker-tapestry.co.uk/2021/03/19/john-dalton-scientist-quaker-and-pioneer/>

William Allen



- [Wellcome Trust Corporate Archive](#)
- ...[Direct activities WT/D](#)
- [Library and Museum WT/D/1](#)
- [Images from the photographic library WT/D/1/20](#)M0007729:

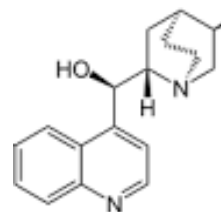
• Interior of the old pharmacy at Plough Court

WT/D/1/20/1/66/62

Plough Court Pharmacy Medicines (1715-1927) [from CursorAI]

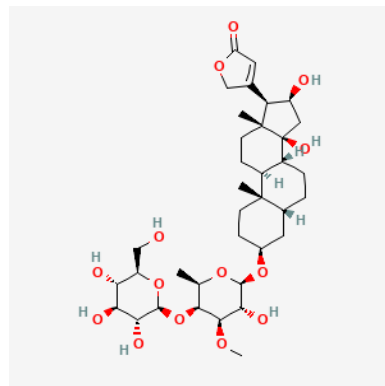
NATURAL:

- **Digitalis (Foxglove):** For heart conditions
- **Willow Bark:** Pain relief and fever reduction (precursor to aspirin)
- **Quinine powder:** Malaria treatment
- **Chamomile:** Digestive issues and anxiety
- **Peppermint: Valerian: Rose Water:**
- **Laudanum:** Opium tincture for pain relief and coughs
- **Elixirs, Cordials, bitters**



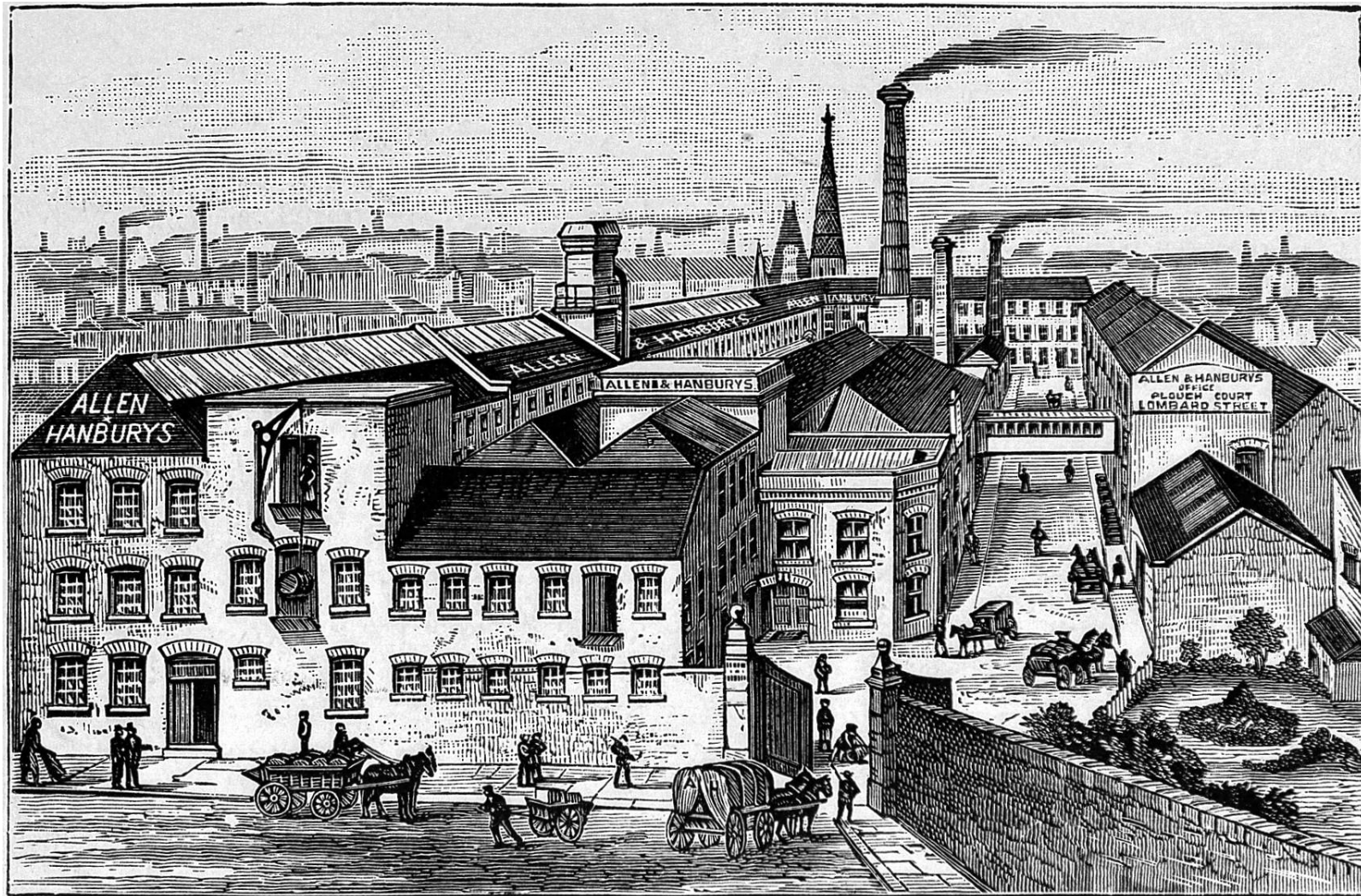
Chemical Compounds

- **Mercury compounds:** For syphilis treatment
- **Calomel (mercurous chloride):** Purgative
- **Antimony:** Emetic and purgative
- **Arsenic preparations, Lead acetate**
- **Sulfur preparations:** For skin problems
- **Zinc oxide ointments:** For wounds and burns
- **Bottles, Scales, equipment, Mortars and pestles, Distillation equipment**
- **Pills and powders: Lozenges:**



A photograph of a multi-story brick building, likely a commercial or industrial structure. The building features a prominent sign that reads "ALLEN & HANBURY'S LTD" in large, white, block letters. The sign is mounted on a horizontal band of lighter-colored material, possibly concrete or plaster, which runs across the middle of the building. Above the sign, there is a row of six large, multi-paned windows. Below the sign, there are two more rows of similar windows, with the bottom row being partially visible. The building is constructed of dark red brick. A flat roof with a metal railing is visible at the top. A small, square brick chimney or ventilation stack is located on the roof, slightly to the left of the center. The sky is blue with some light clouds.

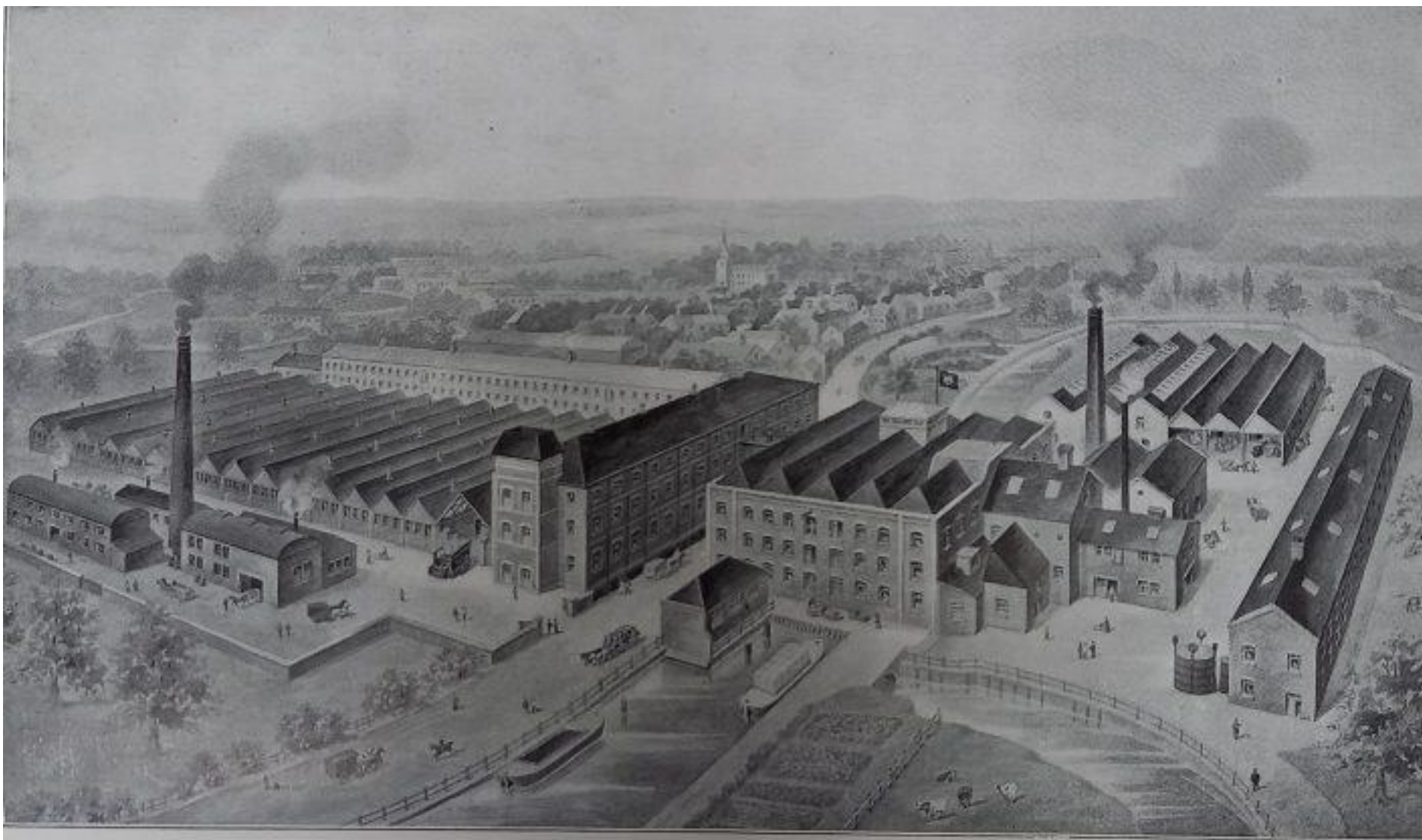
ALLEN & HANBURY'S LTD



GENERAL VIEW OF THE WORKS AT BETHNAL GREEN.

Creator: Wellcome Library, London

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A BIRDSEYE VIEW OF WARE MILLS, HERTFORDSHIRE.

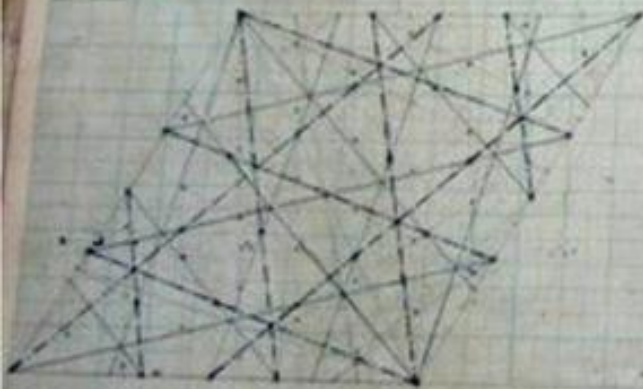
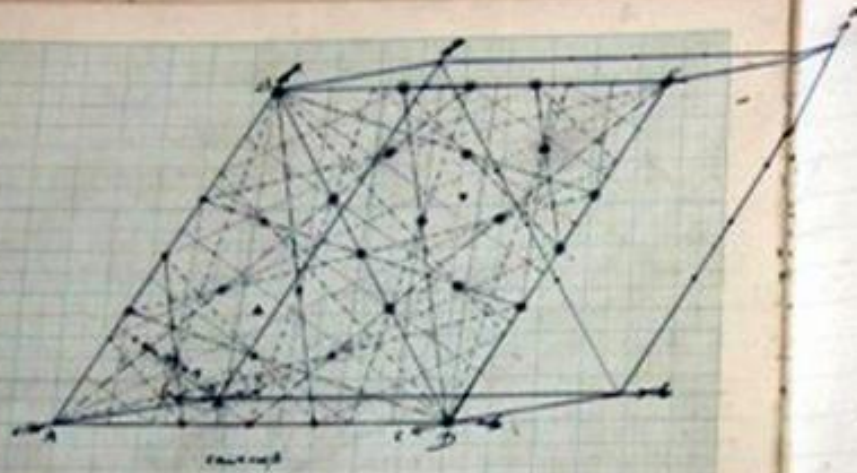
Allen & Hanbury's, Ware showing the factory and mills in 1920
Hertfordshire Archives & Local Studies (Ware.Industries pamphlet file)

Kathleen Lonsdale



Kathleen Lonsdale in her crystallography research laboratory at UCL. Photographer and





$$\sin \frac{A}{2} = \frac{\sin(B+C) \sin(1-C)}{\sin B \sin C} \quad \text{etc.} \quad \sin A = \frac{\sin A + \sin B \sin C}{\sin B \sin C}$$

$$A = \frac{\sin A}{\sin B \sin C} \quad \text{etc.} \quad 2B = A + B + C$$

$$\frac{\sin A}{\sin B} = \frac{\sin B}{\sin C} = \frac{\sin C}{\sin A} \quad \text{etc.}$$

a relation of A results all (A < 60 degrees normally)

$$\frac{1}{2} \text{ also example } \left. \begin{array}{l} A = 50^\circ 20' \\ B = 80^\circ 45' \\ C = 46^\circ 19' \end{array} \right\} \begin{array}{l} \alpha = 4135^\circ 08' \\ \beta = 47^\circ 44' \\ \gamma = 57^\circ 50' \end{array} \quad \left. \begin{array}{l} \sin \alpha \\ \sin \beta \\ \sin \gamma \end{array} \right\}$$

$$\frac{a}{b} = \frac{\sin \alpha}{\sin \beta} = \frac{\sin \gamma}{\sin \alpha} \quad \text{etc.}$$

where (taking mean of all angles)

$$a, b, c = 1.007, 1, 0.5949$$

and N^2 calculated from $a = \frac{\sin \alpha}{N}$ etc.

$$\text{where } N^2 = 4 \sin B \sin (B-m) \sin (1-B) \sin (1-\gamma)$$

$$N = \frac{a+b+c}{2}$$

$$\text{Then where } \log N^2 = 1.54635 \quad \log N = 0.77317 \quad N = 5.922$$

$$d_{100} = 7.832 \quad a = 9.179$$

$$d_{111} = 6.469 \quad b = 7.887$$

$$d_{200} = 3.708 \quad c = 5.600$$

$$\text{where } a, b, c = 1.007, 1, 0.5949$$

$$a, b, c, N, p = m, M, m_n$$

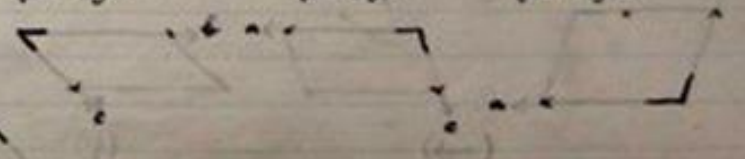
$$M = 162.2 \quad m_n = 1.6449$$

$$\frac{m}{p} = 1.00$$

$$p = 1.060 \quad \text{where } m = 1.060 \quad \text{too large}$$

$$d_{100}, d_{111}, d_{200} \text{ repeated, also } A, B, C$$

looking along A axis for right looking along B looking along C

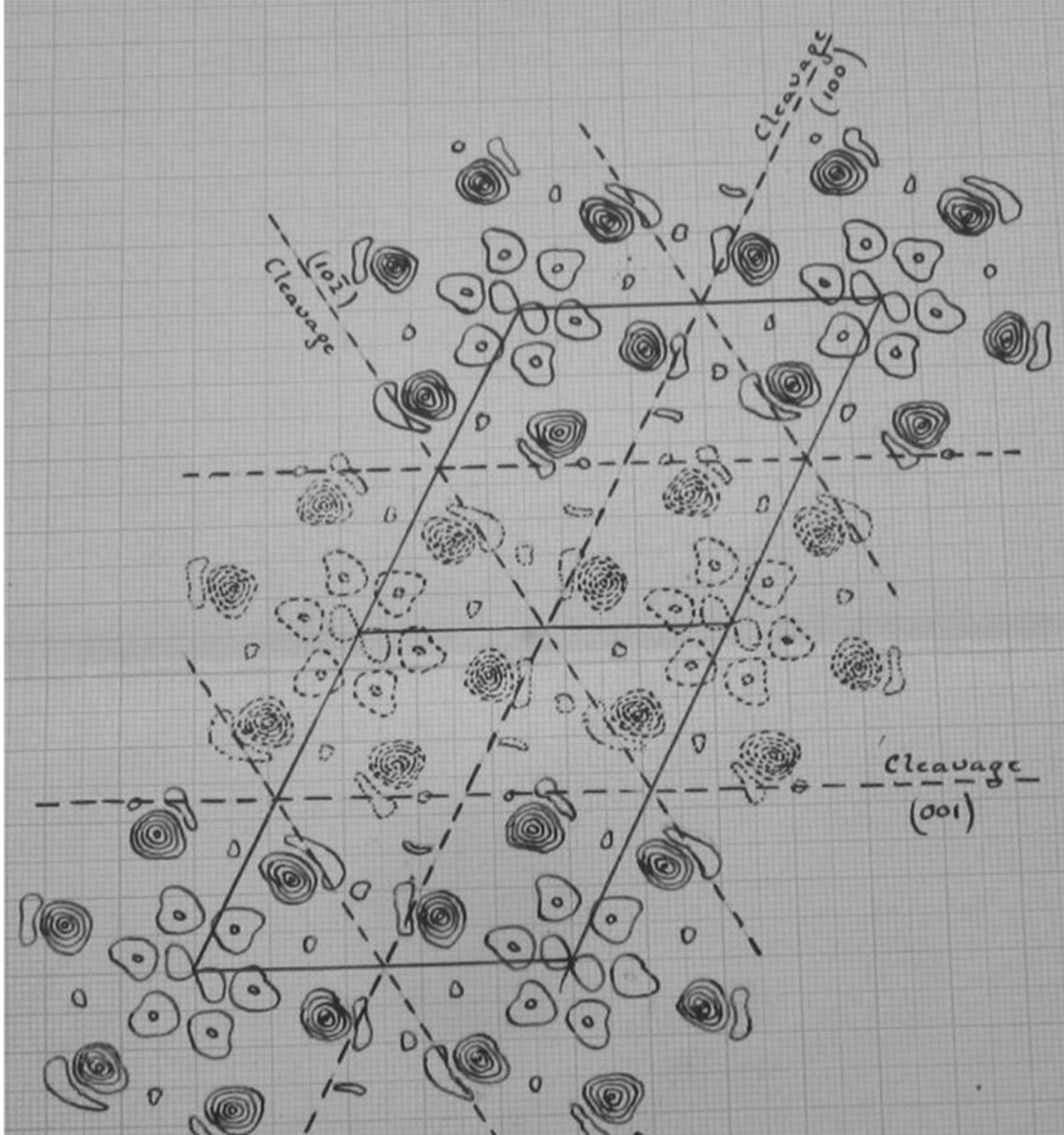


MONOCLINIC SYSTEM.

MONOCLINIC HEMIHEDRY (DOMATIC).

No.	S.-G.	B.L.	<i>n</i> .	Abnormal Spacings.	<i>p</i> .	Possible Molecular Symmetry.
3	C_2^1	Γ_m	2	None	2	P.
4	C_2^2	Γ_m	2	(a.) $\{hol\}$ halved if <i>h</i> is odd (b.) $\{hol\}$ halved if <i>l</i> is odd (c.) $\{hol\}$ halved if (<i>h</i> + <i>l</i>) is odd	—	None.
5	C_2^3	Γ_m' (cf. Γ_0''')	4	(a.) $\{hkl\}$ halved if (<i>h</i> + <i>k</i> + <i>l</i>) is odd	2	P.
		(cf. Γ_0')	4	(b i.) $\{hkl\}$ halved if (<i>k</i> + <i>l</i>) is odd		
		(cf. Γ_0')	4	(b ii.) $\{hkl\}$ halved if (<i>h</i> + <i>k</i>) is odd		
		(cf. Γ_0'')	8	(c.) $\{hkl\}$ halved if (<i>h</i> + <i>k</i>) or (<i>k</i> + <i>l</i>) or (<i>l</i> + <i>h</i>) is odd		
6	C_2^4	Γ_m'	4	(a.) (b i.) (b ii.) Same as C_2^3 (a.) (b i.) (b ii.) respec- tively; also all $\{hol\}$ halved.	—	None.

International Tables for Crystallography (230 spacegroups),
major contributions from Kathleen Lonsdale



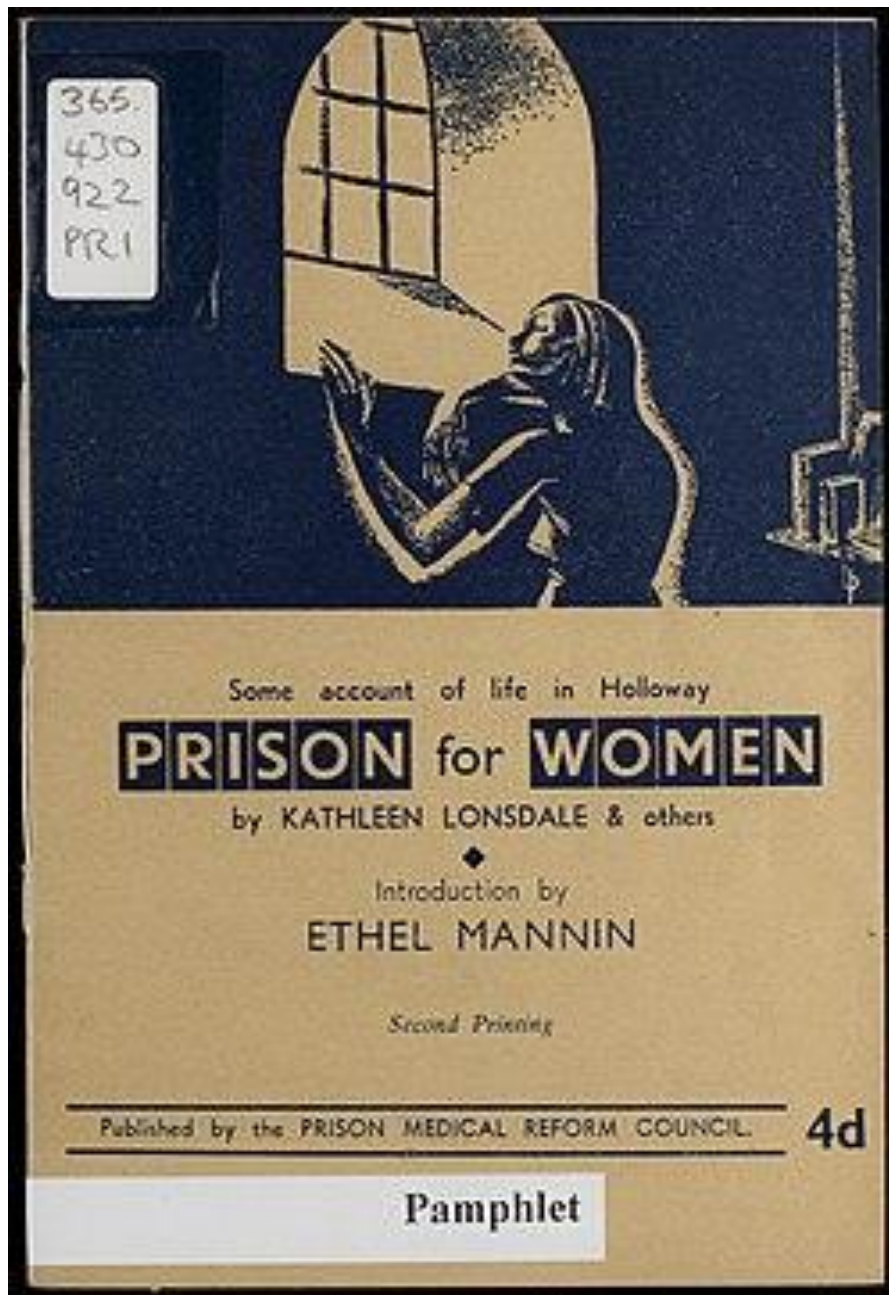
Drawing of the electron density projection on the (010) plane calculated for hexachlorobenzene. Extract from Lonsdale's notebook labelled '1924' Papers of Dame Kathleen Lonsdale UCL Special Collections. Courtesy: The Lonsdale family



Kathleen
Lonsdale

...another baby and I spent most of my time finishing off (by hand, of course, using log tables) the Fourier analysis of hexachlorobenzene. In view of the oft-repeated claims of organic chemists that the crystallographers told them nothing that they did not already know, it may be interesting to reprint a more generous tribute from **C. K. Ingold** (dated 2 November 1931).

‘Ever so many thanks for the reprint of your wonderful paper on Hexachlorobenzene. I have just been studying it in the Royal [Society journals] but am very glad to have it in a handy form. **The calculations must have been dreadful but one paper like this brings more certainty into organic chemistry than generations of activity by us professionals.**’



Of her experience in prison, she said,

“What I was not prepared for was the general insanity of an administrative system In which lip service is paid to the idea of segregation and the ideal of reform, when in practice the opportunities for contamination and infection are innumerable and those responsible for re-education practically nil”.

Kathleen joined the Howard League for Penal Reform and frequently visited women in prison as a form of support.

About these slides

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(Both Graham and Peter have liberal approaches to copyright (CC BY))

Repository. These slides and associated material are at
https://github.com/petermr/quaker_scientists

Use of AI. CursorAI (2025-09) has been used to gather information, primarily from Wikipedia. I have checked most of it for accuracy but there may be slight errors

Knowledge Graphs. These have been created by CursorAI and I am continually revising The protocol. There may be errors